Spark Center
for Innovation in Learning
North American AI Challenge

2026

# Challenge rubric

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| **MVP Development** | **Evaluates the progress, usability, and completeness of the team's prototype.**<br>*How well-developed and functional is the team's MVP or prototype in demonstrating the solution's core value?* |
| **User-Centered Problem** | **Assesses clarity and empathy in defining the problem through the lens of neurodiversity and executive function.**<br>*How clearly and thoughtfully does the team define the problem and user persona, especially in relation to autism, dyslexia, ADHD, or mental health?* |
| **Impact & Inclusivity** | **Evaluates how the solution advances accessibility, empowerment, or opportunity for neurodivergent learners.**<br>*How well does the solution demonstrate or anticipate meaningful impact for neurodivergent users through inclusive design and responsible AI use?* |
| **Functionality** | **Measures whether the demo achieves its intended purpose.**<br>*Does the prototype function as intended and effectively demonstrate its core features?* |
| **Collaboration** | **Assesses teamwork, complementary skills, and inclusive practices.**<br>*How effectively did the team collaborate, leverage diverse strengths, and create an inclusive working environment?* |
| **Principled Innovation** | **Evaluates how meaningfully and responsibly AI or advanced technology is integrated.**<br>*Was AI (or other advanced tech) applied in a way that enhances accessibility, personalization, or learning outcomes?* |
| **Creativity & Vision** | **Examines originality and forward-thinking potential.**<br>*How original, imaginative, or visionary is the team's solution in addressing neurodivergent learning challenges?* |
| **Tools & Techniques** | **Reviews the quality and appropriateness of technical and creative approaches.**<br>*Were the chosen tools, methods, and technologies appropriate, well-integrated, and effectively applied?* |
| **Pitch Storytelling** | **Evaluates clarity, engagement, and adherence to time limits.**<br>*Was the pitch well-structured, engaging, and within the allotted time?* |
| **Growth & Scalability** | **Considers long-term feasibility and real-world potential.**<br>*Does the project show clear potential for growth, adoption, or broader societal impact?* |